

tom half lets you select the type of content you want in the placeholder. When you're ready, click and drag the cursor on your slide to create the placeholder.

You can now close the master view, and your custom layout will be available to you when you create a new slide.

Keeping The Custom Layout Handy

The procedure above only helps you create custom layouts that can be used in the presentation you're working on; to preserve it for use later, you'll need to save the presentation as a template (**Office button > Save As > Other Formats**; select PowerPoint Template (.potx)). Use this template every time you want to use your custom layout/s.

4.3 Working With Content

Text isn't the only thing you get to work with in PowerPoint—you can also add images, Excel tables and charts, videos and diagrams to your presentation—to convey information better as well as add a little life to it. Doing so when you've selected a 'Text and Content' layout for your slide is simple enough—click on the icon in the placeholder, and a dialog box will pop up with options relevant to the type of content you want to add. If you're working on a blank slide, use the Insert menu to achieve the same result. Of course, you'll have to position and resize the object yourself.

4.3.1 Images

To insert an external image (like a photograph or logo) into your slide, go to **Insert > Picture > From File** (**Insert tab > Picture** in PowerPoint 2007). When the picture is placed in the slide, you'll also see the Picture toolbar next to it (in PowerPoint 2007, a new Format tab is created under Picture Tools). The toolbar appears every time you select a picture, and gives you some rather basic tools to edit your image—change brightness and contrast, convert to greyscale or black-and-white, and so on. These aren't terribly advanced, so if you think your image needs considerable atten-